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Title:
Dinner Dilemma

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Publication Date: September 1, 2022

Published by
MUSHROOM CLOUD PRESS
U.S.A.

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Dinner Dilemma

JIM is sitting on the couch working on his laptop when BUD comes into the living room. BUD sits on a chair by the couch and just looks at JIM. JIM glances up and then right back down at his laptop. BUD continues to stare. Finally, JIM stops and looks up.

JIM: What?
BUD: Okay, let's start.
JIM: (Looks at his watch.) Seriously, it's only like ten till six.
BUD: I know, but I got stuff I gotta do.
JIM: Like what?
BUD: (Pauses) Stuff…
JIM: No you don't. If you did I would know about it. You don't have anything to do you're just hungry.
BUD: Yeah I do and yes I am. If we don't start figuring it out now, I won't get to eat until Midnight.
JIM: Alright, but first you gotta tell what it is you have to do.
BUD: You're not my mom. You don't have to know everything I do.
JIM: Hahaha, believe me, your mom doesn't know half the stuff you do.
BUD: Whatever, it's not like I'm a hitman or something. I'm just living the dream, baby. But I gotta eat something and you take forever deciding.
JIM: Well...you still haven't told me what you are doing.
BUD: Oh my Gosh! Why do you always have to be in my business?
JIM: So I can laugh and make fun of you.
BUD: (Looks at JIM and finally decides to tell him.) Ok, ok. I'm going to play disc golf.
JIM: Whatever, liar. You have never played disc golf in your life. We have laughed at those dorks a million times. Those guys wear tiny ponytails, hiking shorts and smell like patchouli oil. They are still carrying around hacky sacks in case the 90'scome back. (changing his voice) "Dude, I haven't seen you since that awesome Blues Traveler concert in Santa Fe. You still living in that VW bus?"

BUD: Haha, yeah that's kind of spot on but this is different.
JIM: How can it be different?
BUD: Well, for one thing I'm not playing disc golf with a bunch of guys...there's this girl.
JIM: (He just stares with mouth open then.) What??
BUD: (Sheepishly) Yeah.
JIM: Where did you meet her? At the Farmers Market selling homemade candles or all natural, organic goat's milk soap?
BUD: You know that pizza I got last night?
JIM: Yeah, but you didn't even leave to pick it up. You got it delivered.
BUD: Uh huh…
JIM: No..no...NO… You did not make a date with the girl who delivered your pizza?
BUD: I did.
JIM: So, what? You didn't have enough money to tip her so you make a date? So this is like, a tip date?
BUD: A tip date is not a thing.
JIM: Well it is now. Let me see if I get this. A girl comes and brings you a pizza, which is actually kinda cool. But she brings you the pizza and instead of giving her a tip, you ask her out on a date?
BUD: No, I tipped her.
JIM: How much?
BUD: What?
JIM: How much did you tip her?
BUD: That doesn't matter.
JIM: I think it does, how much?
BUD: Tipping is a personal thing. I'm not gonna tell you.
JIM: Well, the tip may be the reason she is going out with you. How much?
BUD: (Beat) $20
JIM: $20!!!!! Who are you, Bill Gates ? $20!!!
BUD: It's not that much.

JIM: Not that much! Your whole outfit doesn't cost $20. Of course she's going out with you. She probably thinks you are one of those computer programmer guys who just sold his Start-up and is suddenly crazy rich. Why in the world did you tip her $20?
BUD: Well, she was really cute and when she told me how much it was, I was a little distracted and I gave her two twenty's instead of two ten's. But then I told her to keep the change and right after that I realized what I'd done and I was to scared to ask for the twenty back.
JIM: So instead of getting your change back you double downed and ask her out on a date?
BUD: Yep.
JIM: Does she know those are probably the last twenty's you will have until the end of themonth?
BUD: That's why we are playing disc golf, it's free.
JIM: But not only have you never played disc golf, you don't even have a disc.
BUD: Hibiscus does.
JIM: Hibiscus, what does that mean?
BUD: Hibiscus, that's her name, Hibiscus.
JIM: The pizza girl's name is Hibiscus? Haha, she must be cute. Was she driving a car that ran on vegetable oil? Hibiscus is a flower, right?
BUD: Either that or a type of dinner roll. Not sure
JIM: Now exactly how did you wind up going from tipping like a drunk trust fund baby to going on a disc golf date? Where did that come from?
BUD: She was wearing a t-shirt with a disc golf picture on it. I was looking for a way to chat her up and I said "Cool shirt." And she was like, "I know, right?" and I was like "I love that." And she was like, "We should play." And I said "Uh, yeah we should." Then she said, "Tomorrow?" And I was like, "For sure." Then she gave me her number and we are going to play at 7 o'clock.
JIM: Quick question, how are you going to play? One, you don't have a disc or even a Frisbee. Second, you don't know how to even throw one if you did.
BUD: I got it all figured out. When I get there, I'm gonna look all through my car and act like I can't find it. Then she will probably say, "Use one of mine." I'll say

sure and when I throw the first one, I'm gonna act like hurt my arm or shoulder or something and then we can just walk and talk.
JIM: (Thinks for a second) That's actually not bad. You've put some thought into this.
BUD: And my parents said those 3 years as a college sophomore was a waste. Guess I'm showing them now. What should I wear?
JIM: To play disc golf? The oldest t-shirt you have, those terrible rope sandals you've had since you played a Disciple in that dinner theater production of Jesus Christ Superstar and some ugly shorts. In other words, anything in your closet.
BUD: That's funny. Now that you know what I'm doing can we please decide on what we are eating for dinner?
JIM: Pizza?
BUD: (Stares at him blankly) Wow, you had that ready to go didn't.
JIM: Always be prepared besides I don't have enough money for pizza AND a tip.
BUD: Very funny.
JIM: Wait a minute. Do you realize what you've done?
BUD: What?
JIM: When you screw up and this girl dumps you, like we both know you will.
BUD: Yeah…
JIM: You can never order pizza from that place again.
BUD: Oh no...I didn't think about that. No, no, no...that's my favorite pizza place. They even know that I like that crust almost slightly burned but not so much that you taste the burn, ya know?
JIM: Well, if you weren't so distracted by Hydrangea…
BUD: Hibiscus.
JIM: You wouldn't have created this problem. Cause you will either have to get her fired or find a new pizza place.
BUD: Are those my only options?
JIM: How good are you at disguises?
BUD: I did have a semester of Costume Makeup class and I played that Disciple.

JIM: Well, problem solved. You can go in order a pizza, a 2 liter bottle of Coke and 12 straws.
BUD: You could help me, you know, instead of enjoying my misery.
JIM: Are you kidding? This is better than the last 5 shows I've streamed.
BUD: I can't lose my favorite pizza place.
JIM: Ok, gimme a second here. (Thinks) How about this, you can tell her that you don't like mixing business with pleasure and that dating her would be a problem because you would feel bad having your girlfriend deliver your pizzas.
BUD: But I wouldn't.
JIM: I know that and you know that but Honeysuckle doesn't know that.
BUD: Hibiscus, but you know that's one of my favorite things about having a girlfriend, they can bring me food.
JIM: Which is exactly why you don't have a girlfriend now. You treat them all like they are your personal assistant or something. Only they work for free.
BUD: They aren't working for free, they get *me*.
JIM: Yeah, that's a real plus.
BUD: Instead of destroying my self-esteem, can we figure out how to save me from the loss of my favorite pizza place?
JIM: This is a radical idea but stay with me for a second. How about if you just be honest?
BUD: Hahaha, you got me on that one. That's good.
JIM: (Not smiling) I'm not kidding.
BUD: What do ya mean? Tell her the truth? I can't see you because if you get sick of me, I won't be able to order pizzas anymore?
JIM: Yep.
BUD: This is the best you got? I need a new best friend. You really let me down with this one.
JIM: Or is it so crazy, it might work?
BUD: (Beat) Ya know… the more I think about it...it just might work. If she buys it, she will love my honesty. If she thinks I'm lying, she will hate my guts and she just won't deliver my pizzas anymore. Someone else will have to do it.
JIM: But at least you can still get pizzas from there.

BUD: I think that's it. I'll be honest. That's really good advice. Maybe you should start writing a relationship blog.
JIM: I do give good advice.
BUD: Good, now back to more pressing matters. What are we gonna eat?
JIM: Hmmm, let's see… how about tacos?
BUD: From where?
JIM: I don't know. Tacos are tacos?
BUD: But some places don't have cheese dip and others do.
JIM: You should eat all that if you are about to go on your tip date?
BUD: That's still not a thing but you may be right. How about a burger?
JIM: Nah, I'm not eating anything that has 4 legs.
BUD: What does that mean?
JIM: No pork or beef.
BUD: Since when?
JIM: Since I saw those pictures of people "cow cuddling."
BUD: What's cow cuddling?
JIM: It's a thing that people do to de-stress. They sit down and a cow lays their head in the person's lap and they cuddle. You know, like petting a dog. I saw pictures and the cow's big brown eyes reminded me of my Pugsly and I could never eat my dog. He's so sweet and innocent.
BUD: He's not that sweet, he keeps peeing on our rug.
JIM: Only when it rains.
BUD: And he snores like a freight train.
JIM: Like that's his fault. What do you want me to do?
BUD: Maybe close your door at night, so I don't have to hear it.
JIM: It's not that loud.
BUD: Are you kidding? First night I heard him, I thought you were choking on something.
JIM: Did you check on me?
BUD: Uh, no...what would I do? I'm not an EMT. And I'm sure not sticking my fingers down your throat to clear it.

JIM: Ok, on that we both agree. I don't want your fingers anywhere near my mouth.
BUD: So it's not a health thing or vegan thing, it's a cute animal thing, right?
JIM: Pretty much.
BUD: So what about chickens? They have eyes.
JIM: Yeah, but they're ugly.
BUD: Not as ugly as turkeys.
JIM: Which I can also still eat.
BUD: I hear that chickens are really sweet though and smart.
JIM: Don't ruin this for me, it's all I can do to give up pigs and cows. I gotta have some meat.
BUD: Fair enough, then what about some chicken tenders?
JIM: I could do that. Where do you want them from?
BUD: I don't care, who delivers?
JIM: You think that's such a good idea? You already have one date.
BUD: Fine, I'll pick em up.
JIM: Cool.
BUD: Hey..
JIM: What?
BUD: You want dipping sauce?
JIM: Yeah
BUD: You want fries?
JIM: Yeah
BUD: You want a drink?
JIM: Yeah
BUD Could I borrow some money?
JIM: No, but good try.
BUD: Worth a shot. (He exits)